sides and started baying for his blood. The DGP rang up asking for Army assistance. Would it be possible, he asked, to send a chopper to hover over the jail, slither down, grab the prisoner and then extricate? I told him that yes, while technically feasible, such kind of small team operations are a specialized task carried out by the Special Forces. Furthermore, the location for the extraction had to be secure, which was not the case here. The chopper would be hovering at a very low height and extremely vulnerable to any interference from the mob. The possibility of insurgent cadres armed with AK-47s, mingling with the mob was high. I discussed the matter with the Corps Commander (by then Lt Gen Bipin Rawat had taken over), who concurred with my assessment. Matters came to a head when on 5 March 2015, the mob broke into the jail, going from cell to cell till they located the alleged offender. They dragged him out and paraded him naked, dragging the hapless person to the clock tower, about seven km away, all the while pelting him with stones, before hanging him for all the world to see.[5] The state administration should have been alert to this possibility and taken him to some undisclosed location, preferably outside the state. Tribal affiliations being so strong, no jail within the state would have been safe.

After completing her stint in Myanmar, Veena joined me in Kohima and was there when the Mukalimi incident occurred, keeping all the guests entertained and on a tight leash. Almost the entire family came to visit us at Kohima; Isha and Amala, Simon, my parents, Veena's mother, our brothers and sisters and, of course, our childhood friends. The last were more than happy for me to be posted to distant and exotic places that they could then visit. On the international school circuit, Veena got yet another job offer, this time for the British School in Colombo, Sri Lanka. It was a difficult decision to make, but

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